



r/ Frontend • 4 yr. ago
ssg_partners

What to unit test in frontend?

Most of the articles I find online is explaining 'how' to do you decide this?

It doesn't make sense to me. I feel like unit tests are more around why and 'what' I would test in the frontend (e.g. Redux actions, whether an API call is making the right changes in the UI, etc.). However, I can't see what I would unit test in the 'visual' realm of the things, such as how a layout 'looks' on different devices, the CSS and HTML etc.

↑ 20 ↓

💬 7



🔗 Share

+ Add a Comment

Sort by: Best ▾

🔍 Search Comments



shipandlake • 4y ago

I think these 2 articles would be useful for you:

- <https://kentcdodds.com/blog/write-tests>
- <https://kentcdodds.com/blog/how-to-know-what-to-test>

My team went from unit-testing and mocking everything to more integration based approach, and our confidence in our tests grew dramatically. But it depends what's your motivation for writing tests in the first place.

↑ 9 ↓

💬 Reply



JamesWilsonCodes • 4y ago

I'm a big fan of [cypress](#) for sites that have a lot of interaction, it's not perfect by far, but it's powerful.

↑ 4 ↓

💬 Reply



digitalpencil • 4y ago



Sign in to Reddit with Google



Anthony

anthony.nnaemeka.umeh@gmail.com



fps

fps16k@gmail.com

1 more account

with cypress/similar, and visual regression testing with backstop/similar.

Ultimately testing is all about a) describing a piece(s) of code to yourself and to other future programmers, b) asserting that it behaves precisely as you expect it to and c) having complete confidence that if you inadvertently break something as a result of a change, you know about it because the build will fail.

FE testing can be more convoluted than BE testing but these days there are some great tools to help. Cypress/backstop/percy etc have really closed the gap around e2e/integration and ui-regression testing that was previously so much more cumbersome and annoying.

↑ 3 ↓ Reply ...



dustinechos · 4y ago

If you can't decide what to test, try jest snapshot testing. It's a good way to make a lot of dumb tests. Unfortunately they'll be useless if you refactor, but if you just want to freeze your code and make an alarm go off when anything changes, snapshots are great. You can even render screenshots to "test" your css.

Also, any time you fix a bug that's a good place to add a test.

↑ 1 ↓ Reply ...



collectedme · 4y ago

DOM testing is the best way to test your Frontend code. There are two ways, you can either test the rendered component and test the interactivity of it such as clicking buttons and filling in fields. This would be done through Karma or Jest. The more thorough and expensive test is E2E. You can use cypress or protractor for that.

↑ 1 ↓ Reply ...



shortnamed · 4y ago

Component structure (rendered html), component state mostly (any values, what they are), whether they interact with the outside systems correctly (calls to correct functions with the correct data). If you have complex enough logic in services and or hooks, need to test the logic in those as well.

Just mock everything that's not being tested, and test how it interacts with those systems.

↑ 1 ↓ Reply ...



gabriellvasile · 4y ago · Edited 4y ago

I've created this Javascript Testing Masterclass because the front end testing documentation is so confusing. I hope it helps. <https://youtu.be/MAFGRx0HYKo>

↑ 1 ↓ Reply ...

More posts you may like